SAWANT'S FIVE GROWTH MANTRAS



1. **"To revive the economy post-Covid is a difficult task. We cut wasteful expenditure, worked with the central government to get utilisation certificates and get money stuck with various departments released"**

2. **"We restructured our loans and increased our exposure to government-backed NBFCs like NABARD and SIDBI. Penny saved was a penny earned at that time and we spent the money to augment the infrastructure"**

3. **"We got a lot of support from the central government; as we put it, it was a double-engine growth. We got money from various heads to build tourism, health and road infrastructure etc."**

4. **"There are some groups propelling sub-regional nationalism. They evoke sentiments for jobs. Some people do get carried away. But we are Indians; anyone can come here to do a job or business. We are pursuing the path of nationalism and development"**

5. **"We are reviving the mining sector, and have re-auctioned four mines already. We have sought the Supreme Court's permission to export low-grade iron ore, which no one in Goa or India uses. However, we are committed to auctioning the mines and reviving sustainable practices in the sector"**

TOP PERFORMERS IN BEST PERFORMING CATEGORY

RANK	STATE	APPEARANCES IN TOP 5* (2018-2022)
1	PUDUCHERRY	55
2	GOA	51
3	SIKKIM	44
4	MIZORAM	42
5	DELHI	40

*Across the 12 categories

amendment in the Goa Town and Country Planning Act, which sought to pave the way for the hospitality industry and the entertainment sector to set up film cities. Sawant says, "There are some groups who are propelling sub-regional nationalism; they evoke sentiments for jobs. Some people do get carried away. But we are Indians; anyone can come here to do a job or business. We are pursuing the path of nationalism and development."

The CM is putting in effort to revive the state's second engine of growth—mining. He has already put up four mines for re-auction. The apex court, on December 14, allowed the state to carry on the mine dumping activities in the state, provided they followed safety norms. Goa has several mining dumps scattered around its countryside, essentially comprising waste earth and rock covering a mineral deposit that miners may have rejected in the past. Sawant's regime had asked the top court to relax the bar on iron ore mining, saying it was the main source of livelihood for the state's people. From the year 2012, all mining operations in Goa have been stalled barring the period between September 2015 and March 2018. "We are reviving the mining sector, and have already re-auctioned four mines. We have sought the apex court's permission to export low-grade iron ore, which no one in Goa or India uses. However, we are committed to auctioning the mines and reviving sustainable mining practices," says Sawant. In that will lie his state's and his own future. ■